

ETERNAL

Employee Expense Policy

Version 1.1 | Effective January 2026

Last Updated: March 2026 | Finance Department

1. Policy Overview

Eternal reimburses employees for legitimate, pre-approved business expenses incurred in the performance of their role. This policy sets out what is covered, how to claim, and the timelines involved. All expenditure should represent value for money and be consistent with the company's brand positioning — we are a premium consultancy and our spending should reflect that without being extravagant.

2. Eligible Expenses

- **Business Travel:** Economy-class flights and standard rail fare for any journey required by the business. Where a same-day return is not possible, standard hotel accommodation up to AED 650 per night in Dubai and equivalent regional rates elsewhere. Taxis and ride-hailing for client travel are reimbursable with receipt.
- **Meals and Subsistence:** Daily meal allowance of **AED 120 per day** when travelling on company business or working on a client site more than 20 km from the office. Alcohol is not covered unless part of an approved client entertainment event.
- **Client Entertainment:** Business lunches, dinners, or experiences for clients are reimbursable up to **AED 500 per event**, with advance approval from your Head of Department and a documented business purpose.
- **Professional Development:** Books, online courses, and conference fees directly relevant to your role are reimbursable up to AED 1,500 per year with line manager approval. Conference travel is approved separately.
- **Home Office Equipment:** For permanent remote-hybrid employees, one-off home office equipment (chair, desk lamp, keyboard) up to AED 800 per calendar year, with IT approval.

3. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

- Business or first-class flights without written CFO approval.
- Hotel upgrades, minibar charges, or in-room entertainment.
- Personal grooming, clothing, or luggage (unless lost due to a business travel incident).
- Fines, penalties, or legal costs incurred through personal conduct.
- Gifts for colleagues (team celebrations are handled centrally by People & Culture).
- Subscriptions for personal use, including streaming services, personal software, or gym memberships.
- Expenses incurred more than 45 days prior to submission.

4. How to Submit a Claim

4.1 Submission Process

All expense claims must be submitted via **Expensify**, linked to the employee's Eternal account. Paper forms are not accepted. Claims should be categorised correctly at the point of submission — miscategorised claims will be returned.

4.2 Submission Window

Claims must be submitted within **45 calendar days** of the expense being incurred. Claims outside this window will be declined except in cases of medical leave or other exceptional circumstances approved by the Finance Director.

4.3 Receipt Standards

- Original itemised receipts are required for all claims above AED 50.
- Receipts must be in the name of Eternal or the employee — personal receipts without business context will be rejected.
- For cash expenses where no receipt was provided, a written declaration may be submitted for amounts below AED 80 with line manager countersignature.
- Credit card statements are not accepted as sole evidence of expenditure.

5. Approval Authority

Claim Amount (AED)	Required Approver
Up to 500	Line Manager
501 to 2,500	Head of Department
2,501 to 10,000	COO
Above 10,000	CFO + CEO co-approval

6. Currency and Foreign Exchange

Expenses incurred in foreign currencies must be converted to AED at the mid-market rate on the date of the transaction, as shown on the bank statement or card statement. Reimbursement will be made in AED via payroll. Any currency conversion loss is borne by the company; speculative conversion is not permitted.

7. Reimbursement Timeline

Approved expenses are processed in the **following month's payroll run**, provided claims are approved by the 15th of the current month. Claims approved after the 15th roll to the subsequent payroll cycle. Employees will receive an automated Expensify notification when their claim is approved and when payment has been processed.

8. Fraud and Misuse

Submission of false, inflated, or duplicate expense claims constitutes gross misconduct and will be subject to disciplinary action, including dismissal and, where appropriate, civil or criminal proceedings. The Finance team performs periodic audits of all expense submissions.